



M2 COMMUNITY NODE

Meshtastic Operator Cheatsheet

PRE-EVENT (24-48 HRS BEFORE)

Node already configured? Skip flash/discover steps.

You only need to rotate the PSK and regenerate the QR. Config takes ~5 min. Do it at least 24 hrs before the event.

Rotate PSK

Update PSK in both scripts

CHANNEL_PSK_B64 in config_heltec_v3.py AND gen_m2_channel_qr.py

```
python scripts/config_heltec_v3.py
```

```
python scripts/gen_m2_channel_qr.py
```

Print QR cards

community-outreach/pdf/M2_Mesh_ChannelQR_DayOf.pdf — 2 per sheet

Print connection cards

M2_Mesh_Connection_Card.pdf — laminate for reuse

Save New PSK

Test 2 phones on the channel

Pair via Bluetooth, scan QR, send a message

Verify MQTT bridge is running on Pi 2

```
sudo systemctl status meshtastic-mqtt
```

POST-EVENT

Note any hardware issues or node resets

Archive event PSK to M2_SECRETS.md

Mark as expired — never reuse

Verify both nodes reporting to MQTT

Update handoff PDF if config changed

```
python meshtastic/scripts/generate_m2_mesh_handoff.py
```

DAY-OF

Set out QR cards at check-in

Scan yours first — confirm CommunityNode appears in app

Brief new users

App → Bluetooth → scan QR → set name → message

Confirm both M2-1 and M2-2 are routing

Meshtastic app → Nodes — both should show recent heartbeat

Note who is on the channel

Confirm organizers have working radios before dispersing

WHEN SOMETHING BREAKS

Problem	Fix
App won't connect to node	Toggle BT off/on, force-close app, reopen
Nodes not routing messages	Check both show in app node list, move closer
QR scan does nothing	Update Meshtastic app — older versions can't import
Channel PSK mismatch	Re-run config_heltec_v3.py and gen_m2_channel_qr.py
Node offline in MQTT	ssh pi2 — sudo systemctl restart meshtastic-mqtt
Node won't boot	Hold PWR 3s. Check USB power. Reflash if needed.
GPS no fix	Nodes have no built-in GPS — use phone location in app
Can't find node in BT scan	Short press reset. Toggle phone BT off/on.

QUICK COMMANDS

```
python meshtastic/scripts/config_heltec_v3.py
  Push PSK + config to both nodes
```

```
python meshtastic/scripts/gen_m2_channel_qr.py
  Regenerate day-of QR card
```

```
python meshtastic/scripts/generate_m2_mesh_handoff.py
  Rebuild handoff PDF
```

```
python meshtastic/scripts/generate_m2_mesh_cheatsheet.py
  Rebuild this cheatsheet
```

```
python meshtastic/scripts/generate_m2_mesh_runbook.py
  Rebuild runbook PDF
```